



BITS Pilani presentation

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SS ZG622

Software Project Management

Lecture No. 3

Project goals & objectives and project charter



1. Goals vs objectives
2. Defining project goals and project management goals
3. Mapping goals to SMART objectives
4. Preparing project charter

1. Goals vs objectives



Goals vs. objectives

Aspect	Goals	Objectives
Definition	Broad, general intentions or outcomes to be achieved	Specific, measurable steps/actions to achieve the goals
Nature	Qualitative, high-level	Quantitative, detailed
Time Frame	Long-term (whole project or beyond)	Short- to medium-term
Measurability	Often hard to measure directly	Always measurable
Scope	Strategic — align with vision or business drivers	Tactical — tied to deliverables and milestones
Who Uses It	Sponsors, executives, customers	Project managers, team members
Example	“Enhance customer experience”	“Reduce average online ticket booking time by 30% in 3 months”

Goal and corresponding objectives - an example



Goal - Become fit by healthy eating and regular exercise

Objectives ?



Goal and corresponding objectives - an example



Goal - Become fit by healthy eating and regular exercise

Objectives:

- *Prepare and eat home-cooked meals at least 5 days a week for the next 3 months.*
- *Limit added sugar consumption to no more than 25 grams per day for the next 6 weeks.*
- *Eat at least 3 servings of vegetables daily for 30 consecutive days.*
- *Walk or jog for at least 30 minutes, 5 times per week, for the next 12 weeks.*
- *Do strength training exercises twice a week (Monday and Thursday) for 8 weeks.*

2. Defining project goals and project management goals

Project goals vs. Project management goals



	Project Goals	Project Management Goals
Examples	Improving customer experience, increasing revenue	Completing the project on time, staying within budget
Focus	High-level outcomes the project aims to achieve	Successful execution and delivery of the project
Purpose	Align with broader business objectives	Manage project constraints like time, budget, and scope
Scope	Broad and ongoing, often tied to business performance	Specific to the project lifecycle, time-bound to the project's duration
Metrics	Business performance metrics (e.g., customer satisfaction)	Project-specific metrics (e.g., timeline adherence, risk management)
Time Frame	Can be continuous or long-term	Limited to the duration of the project
Alignment	Tied to the end results or deliverables of the project	Focused on the process of achieving those results

Activity - W03#1



Define three goals

- a) for the Mux Core project and
- b) for its project management

3. Mapping goals to SMART objectives

Project objectives vs

Project management objectives



Project objectives

- define the **desired outcomes or deliverables**, focusing on the **end product or system** and its alignment with business goals.
- describe **what** the project aims to achieve in terms of functionality, performance, and value to the organization.
- centered on the **product** and its impact on stakeholders, such as customers, employees, or the business.

PM objectives

- focus on the **process of delivering the project**, emphasizing how the project is planned, executed, and controlled to ensure successful completion.
- describe **how** the project will be managed to achieve the project objectives.
- centered on the **project execution**, including timelines, budgets, resources, risks, and stakeholder coordination.

SMART is a framework to ensure objectives are clear and actionable



- **Specific:** Clearly defined, answering who, what, where, when, or why.
 - **Measurable:** Quantifiable to track progress and confirm success.
 - **Achievable:** Realistic given resources, constraints, and capabilities.
 - **Relevant:** Aligned with project and organizational priorities.
 - **Time-bound:** Tied to a deadline or timeframe for completion.
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- ❑ *Prepare and eat home-cooked meals at least 5 days a week for the next 3 months.*
- ❑ *Eat at least 3 servings of vegetables daily for 30 consecutive days.*
- ❑ *Walk or jog for at least 30 minutes, 5 times per week, for the next 12 weeks.*



Example objective for improving customer satisfaction

Objective: "Increase the average customer satisfaction score for the online ticket purchasing process by 15% within the next six months."

- ***Specific:*** Focus on customer satisfaction during the online ticket purchasing process.
- ***Measurable:*** The 15% increase in the satisfaction score.
- ***Achievable:*** Through targeted improvements in user interface and customer support.
- ***Relevant:*** Directly tied to enhancing customer experience.
- ***Time-bound:*** Achieve within six months.

Activity - W03#2



Define SMART objectives corresponding to the given ACL Mux Core Project goals

Activity - W03#3



Define SMART objectives
corresponding to the given ACL Mux Core
project management goals

4. Preparing project charter

Project charter

A foundational document that officially authorizes the existence of a project and gives the project manager the authority to use organizational resources to execute the project.

Key Purpose

- Formally authorizes the project.
- Aligns all stakeholders on the project's objectives, scope, and purpose.
- Establishes the project manager's authority.
- Serves as a reference point throughout the project lifecycle.

Typical contents of project charter

- Project purpose
- Project objectives
- Project management objectives
- Scope (in-scope and out-of-scope)
- Execution approach
- Key deliverables
- Timeline
- Budget
- Stakeholders
- Risks and mitigation
- Assumptions
- Constraints
- Approval



Project charter comparison

Aspect	Plan-Driven (e.g., Waterfall)	Agile (e.g., Scrum)
Purpose	Define entire scope, timeline, and deliverables up front	Align on product vision, goals, and team expectations
Detail Level	High: includes full scope, WBS, budget, Gantt chart, etc.	Lean: high-level goals, constraints, product roadmap
Change Flexibility	Low: changes after charter require formal re-approval	High: changes expected; charter reflects flexible goals
Ownership	Sponsor + PM-driven	Product Owner + Team-driven with PM facilitation
Planning Horizon	Full project duration	Current release or increment (1–3 months)
Use in Execution	Reference for contract, fixed deliverables	Alignment tool for iterations/sprints

Summay



1. Differences between goals and objectives
2. How to define project goals and project management goals
3. Mapping goals to SMART objectives
4. Purpose of creating a project charter

Stepwise project planning (from Textbook #1)



Step 1 - Identify project scope and objectives



- Step 1.1 - Identify objectives and practical effectiveness measures to meet those objectives
- Step 1.2 - Establish project authority
- Step 1.3 - Identify all stakeholders and their interests
- Step 1.4 - Modify objectives in the light of stakeholder analysis
- Step 1.5 - Establish methods of communication with all parties

Step 2 - Identify project infrastructure



Step 2.1 - Identify relationship between the project and strategic planning

Step 2.2 - Identify installation standards and procedures

Step 2.3 - Identify project team organization

Step 3 - Analyse project characteristics



- Step 3.1 - Distinguish the project as either objective-driven or product-driven
- Step 3.2 - Analyse other project characteristics
- Step 3.3 - Identify high-level project risks
- Step 3.4 - Take into account user requirements concerning the implementation
- Step 3.5 - Select development methodology and life-cycle approach
- Step 3.6 - Review overall resource estimates

Step 4 - Identify project products and activities



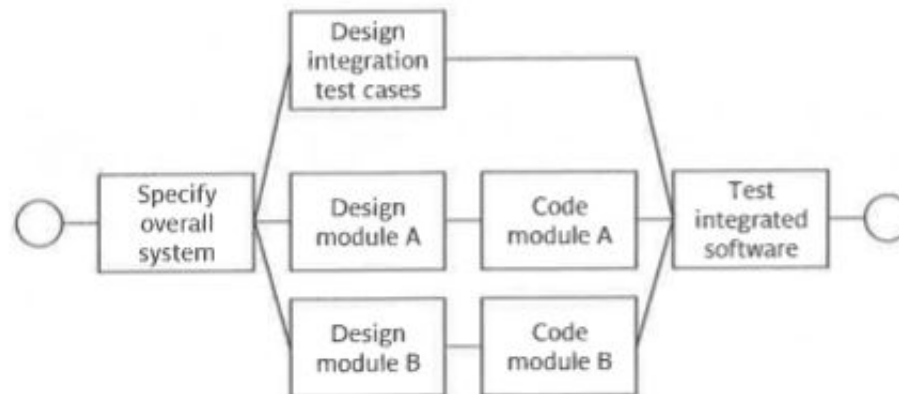
Step 4.1 - Identify and describe project products or deliverables

Step 4.2 - Document generic product flows

Step 4.3 - Recognize product instances

Step 4.4 - Produce ideal activity network

Step 4.5 - Modify the ideal to take into account need for stages and checkpoints



Software project management (6e) - introduction © The McGraw-Hill Companies, 2018

Step 5 - Estimate effort for each activity



Step 5.1 - Carry out bottom-up estimates

Step 5.2 - Revise plan to create controllable activities

Step 6 - Identify activity risks

Step 6.1 - Identify and quantify activity-based risks

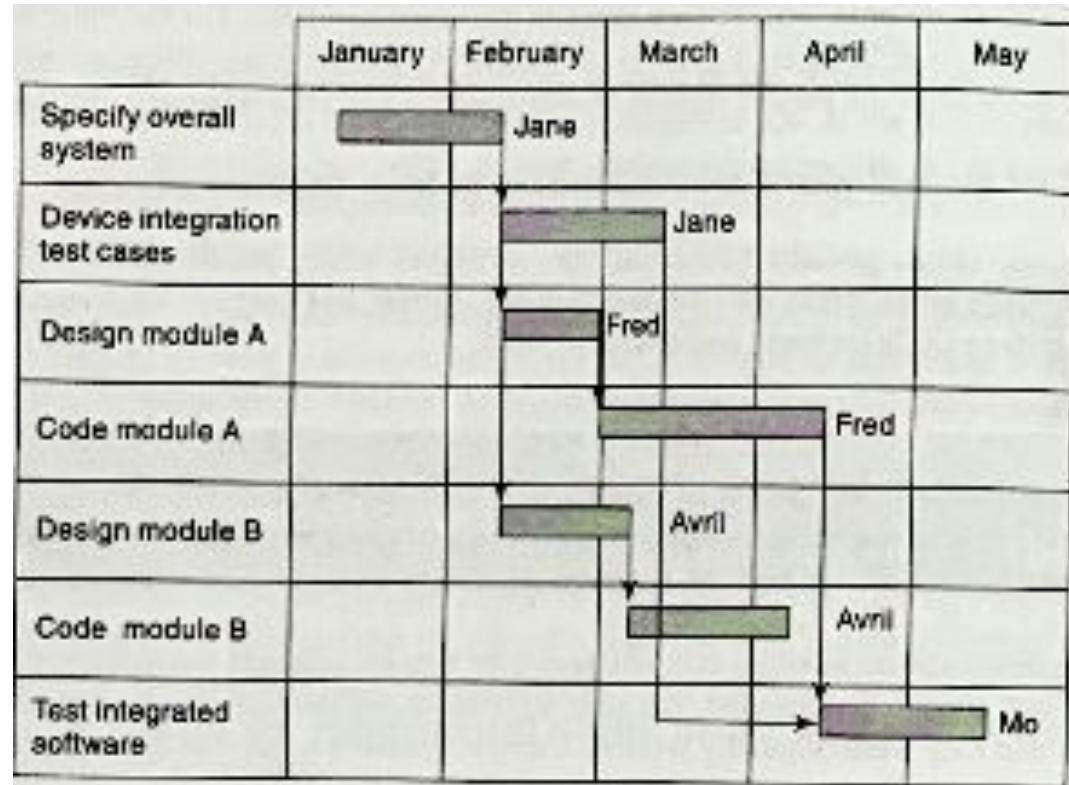
Step 6.2 - Plan risk reduction and contingency
measures where appropriate

Step 6.3 - Adjust overall plans and estimates to take
account of risks

Step 7 - Allocate resources

Step 7.1 - Identify and allocate resources

Step 7.2 - Revise plans and estimates to take into account resource constraints





Step 8 - Review/publicize plans

Step 8.1 - Review quality aspects of the project plan

Step 8.2 - Document plans and obtain agreements

Steps 9 and 10 - Execute plan and perform lower level planning